

Unit 2 Further Listening P30

Conversation

1 What is one of the things the woman wishes for at first?

- A Learning to swim.
- B Finding a well-paid job.
- C Seeing her husband soon.
- D Getting married in a big house.

2 What difficulties did the man experience in his life?

- A He had a hard time keeping his marriage.
- B He got really sick and lost all his valuable things.
- C He lost his job and wealth and was sick for years.
- D He was unable to see his children due to poor health.

3 According to the man, why is true love important for a happy life?

- A It helps one value little things in life.
- B It makes couples appreciate each other.
- C It gives people patience in their job search.
- D It makes people confident in pursuing their goals.

4 What is the purpose of the man striking up the conversation?

- A To tell the woman an interesting life story.
- B To teach the woman skills to find a good job.
- C To encourage the woman to pursue a happy marriage.
- D To give the woman advice on the important things in life.

Scripts:

M: Nancy, if you had a chance to make three wishes, what would they be?

W: Hmm ... I want a high-paying job, a handsome husband, and a big house ... with a swimming pool!

M: Wow, Nancy! Those are your three wishes?

W: Of course! If I have those three things, I'll be happy!

M: Now, Nancy. Let me tell you my story, and you may see things differently afterward.

W: See things differently? What do you mean, Uncle Charlie?

M: Here is what I once experienced in life. When I married 32 years ago, we had a happy marriage, a beautiful house, two expensive cars, and \$200,000 in the bank!

W: See, just like now!

M: But that is not the whole story. Within six years of our marriage, we had three beautiful children, but we lost our jobs, our house, and all our money, and then I got really sick for nine years.

W: Oh, Uncle Charlie. That must have been rough!

M: Yes, it was. But we didn't lose anything truly valuable, because we always said, "Wherever the five of us are together, that's home!" And, little by little, things did improve, and I finally got well. So, I would suggest you make three different wishes.

W: What would those be? I am eager to hear.

M: Well ... I suggest these three wishes: patience, courage, and love!

W: Patience, courage, and love?

M: Yes! These are what make life full, strong, and happy! If you have patience and courage, you won't give up your goals easily, and you can overcome any difficulties. Hence, you will get what you really want in life.

W: This is good. What about love?

M: If you have true love, you and your husband will be beautiful to each other no matter how old you become.

W: I am starting to get what you mean. I will remember. Patience, courage, and love! Thanks, Uncle Charlie!

Passage

1 What is predicted about the human population in the next three decades?

- A The proportion of 15- to 50-year-olds will decrease slightly.
- B The number of people aged 80 and above will increase by about 22%.
- C The proportion of people aged 60 and above will increase significantly.
- D The number of 12- to 22-year-olds will decrease by more than 420 million.

2 What is one impact of an aging human population on society?

- A Economic productivity is constantly rising.
- B The range of healthcare services is expanding.
- C The pension system will be replaced in the near future.
- D The ratio of working-age people to older people is decreasing.

3 What may be a result of the population changes discussed in the passage?

- A Instability of housing prices.
- B Changes in family structure.
- C An increase in property taxation.
- D A decrease in population mobility.

4 What does human society need according to the speaker?

- A Strong trade ties between countries around the world.
- B Effective policies to reduce social and health costs.
- C Necessary changes to address the needs of older people.
- D Rich resources to maintain the traditional family structure.

Scripts:

Of all the threats to human society, including war, disease, and natural disaster, one cannot be ignored. It is the aging of the human population.

It is estimated that the proportion of the world's population aged over 60 years will nearly double between 2015 and 2050, increasing from 12 percent to 22 percent. The number of people aged 80

years or older is expected to triple between 2020 and 2050 to reach about 426 million.

This change will have profound impacts on human society. One problem concerns the ratio of the number of working-age people to the number of older people, which is known as the “potential support ratio”. This index has fallen from 10.1 in 1950 to 6.1 in 2020 and is expected to drop to 3 in 2050. Its decline means that the burden on the young, economically and socially, will rise accordingly. This is because older people rely on the young not only for care and support but also for the economic productivity that ensures pensions can be paid and health and social costs can be met.

A variety of issues in other areas, such as family composition, taxation, and housing, may originate from the population “age-quake”, too. For instance, increased mobility may weaken the traditional family structure, and the demand for residential and nursing homes will increase.

No matter what the future reality will be, the aging of the human population certainly presents a challenge to policymakers, economists, and healthcare specialists around the world. This suggests that human society will need to be transformed into a structure that has the ability and resources to address the diverse needs of older people.

Lecture 1

1 What is the most reliable predictor of one’s chances of getting age-related diseases?

- A Year of birth.
- B Biological age.
- C Chronological age.
- D Number of body cells.

2 How is biological age measured?

- A By comparing how old one looks and how old one really is.
- B By identifying the diseases one has suffered in chronological order.
- C By examining biological evidence of one’s physical and mental functions.
- D By analyzing the current health status of one’s family members and relatives.

3 What does the speaker say about the importance of genetic influence on biological age?

- A It has not been studied until recent decades.
- B It cannot be measured effectively through DNA research.
- C It has been supported by a lot of research in recent decades.
- D It is equal to that of environmental factors and lifestyle choices.

4 What does the speaker say about healthy lifestyle choices?

- A They can help reverse one’s biological age.
- B They can improve one’s exercise routine in the long run.
- C They can reduce one’s exposure to stressful environments.
- D They can benefit the economic status of certain population groups.

Scripts:

If you're like most people, when asked how old you are, you will probably give your answer based on how many candles were, or should have been, on your last birthday cake. That is your chronological age. But did you know there is a lesser-known way to classify age? It's called biological age.

So, what is the difference between chronological age and biological age?

Chronological age, or calendar age, is the most common way we define age. Your chronological age refers to the number of years that have passed since you were born. However, chronological age is not a reliable indicator of how quickly your body will decline or how likely you are to develop age-related disorders. That's why it's important to think about your biological age as well.

Biological age -- also known as physiological age -- refers to how old your body cells and tissues are based on physiological evidence. It is measured by a combination of biological markers that indicate your physical and mental functions.

Studies show that biological age is a better measure of aging and one's current health status. For example, assume your chronological age is 25, but your biological markers are close to those of an average 40-year-old. This would indicate that you are aging at a faster rate than expected. Therefore, research on biological age can shed light on the aging process and provide a better picture of what contributes to healthy aging.

Various factors can affect your biological age. An important one is genetics. Research in recent decades has reported a number of observations that support the influence of genetic factors.

Multiple genes that influence longevity have been identified. These include genes that repair DNA, genes that protect cells from damage, and genes that regulate fat levels.

Though being important, genes account for only 20 percent to 30 percent of biological age. Environmental factors and lifestyle choices can also have varying degrees of influence. Such parameters include exposure to tobacco or other pollutants, sleep habits, stress management, physical exercise, and diet, among others.

So, although it is impossible to turn back the clock in terms of your chronological age, the good news is that it is possible to reverse your biological age, say, by making smart lifestyle choices. This could mean following a healthy lifestyle, including adopting a healthier diet and committing to a regular exercise routine.

With the fast growth of the world's aging population, understanding the biological aging process is critical not only for individual health but also for the social and economic health of our society.

Lecture 2

1 What does the speaker mainly talk about?

- A Distinctions between concrete thinking and abstract thinking.
- B Similarities between cognitive skills and formal logical thinking.
- C Features of cognitive development in different phases of adolescence.
- D Definitions of three thinking patterns developed during the teenage period.

2 What does complex thinking focus on during one's early adolescent years?

- A Decisions about personal life in school and home settings.
- B Development of a code of ethics and personal relationships.
- C Arrangement and order of concrete objects and simple actions.

D Analysis and understanding of other people's ideas and opinions.

3 During which period are children most likely to think a lot about global issues?

A Ages 6-12.

B Ages 13-15.

C Late adolescence.

D Early adolescence.

4 What does the speaker suggest parents and teachers should do?

A Encourage children to focus on their current goals.

B Be patient with children's mistakes in cognitive thinking.

C Give children the freedom to keep their thoughts to themselves.

D Support the healthy development of cognitive skills in children.

Scripts:

Cognitive development means the development of the ability to think and reason. This growth demonstrates distinct features in different age periods. Children aged 6 to 12 usually think in concrete ways, known as "concrete operations". This can include things like how to combine, separate, order, and transform objects and actions. Adolescence, the period from age 13 to 19, marks the beginning of the development of more complex thinking processes, also called "formal logical operations". These can include abstract thinking, the ability to form new ideas, and the ability to compare or debate different opinions.

During adolescence, teenagers gain the ability to think systematically about all logical relationships within a problem. Every adolescent progresses at their own rate in developing complex cognitive skills. But generally, cognitive changes in adolescence consist of three phases: early adolescence, middle adolescence, and late adolescence. Each stage is characterized by some common features indicating growth from simpler to more complex cognitive skills.

During early adolescence, the use of more complex thinking is focused on personal decision-making in school and home environments. Children begin to demonstrate the use of formal logical operations in schoolwork. They also start to form their own views on a variety of topics related to their own lives, such as which sports are better to play, what kinds of appearances are attractive, or what parental rules should be changed.

Cognitive development in middle adolescence often includes more philosophical and futuristic concerns. In this phase, children begin to question and analyze more extensively, form their own code of ethics, develop their identity, and think long-term. They also start to consider future goals, make their own plans, and explore how to influence relationships with others.

During late adolescence, complex thinking processes focus on less self-centered topics. Children have increased thoughts about global concepts such as justice, history, and politics; they develop idealistic views on specific topics or concerns. They also begin to focus their thinking on making career decisions and their emerging role in adult society.

Since adolescence is a critical period of cognitive development, parents and educators should foster

healthy cognitive growth in teenagers. They can encourage children to share ideas and thoughts with adults, think independently, set future goals, and make well-thought-out decisions. It's not easy to be perfect, but adolescents can be best prepared for tackling challenges in adulthood if they are provided with solid support in this crucial stage of their development.

Keys:

Conversation: B C B D

Passage: C D B C

Lecture 1: BCCA

Lecture 2: CACD